



Giraffokeryx

jee-RAFF-oh-CARE-icks



- **When** 16–5 million years ago (Neogene)
- **Fossil location** Asia, Europe, Africa
- **Habitat** Grasslands
- **Length** 5¼ ft (1.6 m)
- **Diet** Plants

Today, there are only two living members of the giraffe family: the giraffe and the okapi. In the past there were many more, including *Giraffokeryx*. It had two pairs of pointed, furry horns—one pair on its head and another on its snout. At the back of its jaws were ridged teeth, well suited to grinding tough plants.

▲ **LONG TONGUE**
Giraffokeryx probably had a long, flexible tongue to select the tastiest leaves.

Cranioceras

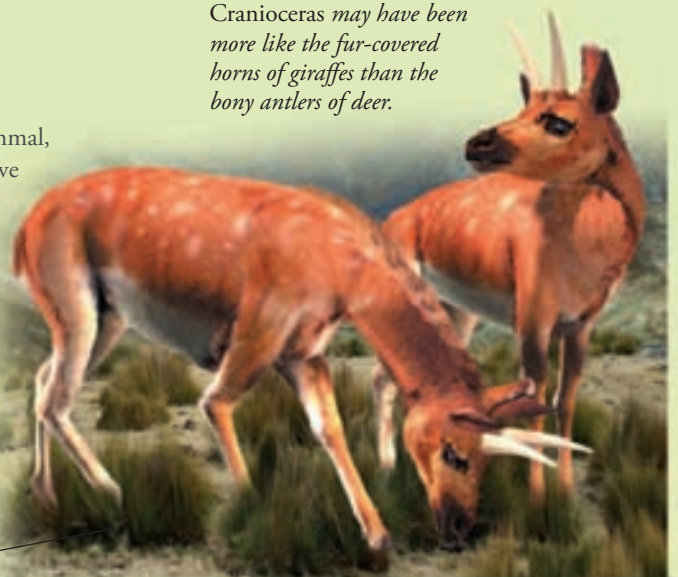
CRAY-knee-OSS-eh-rass



- **When** 20–5 million years ago (Neogene)
- **Fossil location** N. America
- **Habitat** Woodlands
- **Length** 3 ft (1 m)
- **Diet** Leaves

A hoofed, cud-chewing mammal, *Cranioceras* was a close relative of early deer and giraffes. Males had two short, straight horns over their eyes and a thick, blunt horn that curved up at the back of the head. Injuries on fossilized horns suggest they were used in fights over mates or territories.

▼ **THE HORNS of**
Cranioceras may have been more like the fur-covered horns of giraffes than the bony antlers of deer.



Two-toed feet, ideal for running at speed

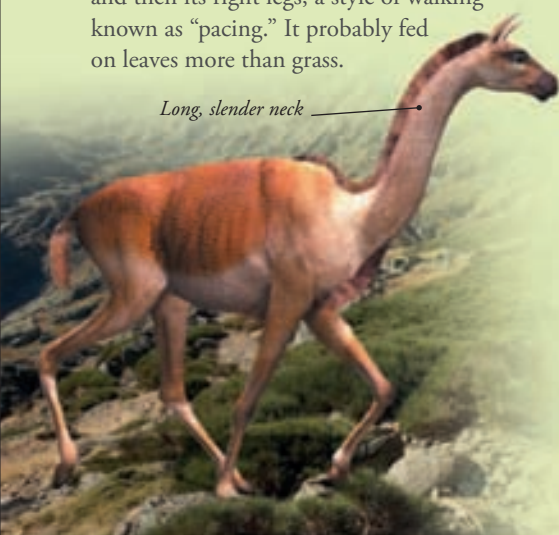
Aepycamelus

AY-peeH-CAM-ell-us

- **When** 15–5 million years ago (Neogene)
- **Fossil location** USA
- **Habitat** Woodlands and grasslands
- **Length** 11 ft (3 m)
- **Diet** Plants

Aepycamelus was a camel but looked a little like a giraffe—it was very tall, with a long neck. It could run fast on its long legs, each of which had two hoofed toes with broad pads underneath. Like all camels and giraffes, it walked by swinging its left legs together and then its right legs, a style of walking known as “pacing.” It probably fed on leaves more than grass.

Long, slender neck



Stenomylus

STEN-oh-MILE-us

- **When** 25–16 million years ago (Late Paleogene–Early Neogene)
- **Fossil location** USA
- **Habitat** Grasslands
- **Size** 2 ft (60 cm) tall
- **Diet** Grass

Stenomylus was a small camel. Its neck, legs, and body were delicate and slender, more like those of a gazelle than a modern camel. Unlike modern camels, *Stenomylus* walked on tiptoe. It had huge molar teeth with very deep roots. These must have been used for chewing very tough or gritty plants, as fossilized teeth show signs of extreme wear during the life of the animal.

Long neck

Slender legs

Hoof

